

» AFTER

In retrospect, the Mayaguez mission was seen as poorly planned and executed, in spite of the heroism involved.

ON REFLECTION

The US recognized the heroism displayed by Marines, Navy, and Air Force personnel in the combined response to the Mayaguez Incident by awarding one Navy Cross and 12 other major citations, in addition to bronze stars to the 23 men who died in the helicopter crash in Thailand.

Their service has not been forgotten. In 2008, more than 30 years after the incident, a law was drafted to award the Vietnam War Service Medal to veterans of the mission, who had previously been ineligible. In addition, collaborative efforts between Cambodia and the US to **find and repatriate bodies** from Koh Tang continue today.



VIETNAM WAR SERVICE MEDAL